

INTERNATIONAL SAND ART FESTIVAL

Konark, Odisha: **Dec. 1, 2023**

INTERNATIONAL KITE FESTIVAL

Ahmedabad, Gujarat ▶
Jan. 14, 2023



SURAJKUND INTERNATIONAL CRAFTS MELA

Surajkund, Haryana
Feb. 1-19, 2023 ▼





◀ **Beach Cleaning Drives**

Pravasi Bharatiya Diwas

Indore, Madhya Pradesh
Jan. 9, 2023

University Outreach

- **75 universities for G20 Public Outreach**
- **Pan-India, year-long**

culturally enriching, mentally rejuvenating and physically invigorating" for the visiting delegates. They will be attending the major festivals of India, be it the kite festival in Ahmedabad, the sand art festival in Konark, the crafts mela in Surajkund, the Hornbill music festival in Kohima and the dance festival in Khajuraho, all of which have been dovetailed with G20 events to project India's soft power. There will also be beach cleaning drives as part of India's Lifestyle for Environment mission to solve the global climate crisis. Projected as the 'mother of democracy', India's efforts in women-led development will be highlighted, while digital hackathons will demonstrate the major strides it has made in digital inclusion and transformation. The pitch extends to the delegates' kits, which will project the arts and crafts of various states, whether it is Bihar's Madhubani art on coffee mugs, Kashmir's Kani work on bottles or Kanjivaram and Gond designs on the bags for the delegates.

NOW FOR THE HARD PART

All this is expected to transform the G20's usually staid meetings into a global spectacle that is enlightening, entertaining and exhilarating. But the key to the success of India's presidency will lie in its ability to navigate the members through a handful of choppy issues and arrive at a constructive consensus that could yield significant results. Foremost among them is the ongoing Ukraine war that has caused worldwide economic disruption, including a food and fuel crisis, in addition to rising inflationary trends. India walks a tightrope on the issue as Russia is a close friend, and has supplied both fuel and fertilisers to India at a reasonable price throughout the crisis. Though the US and Europe have acknowledged India's constraints, they have found themselves grinding their teeth in frustration on several occasions over India's ambiguous stand. But Modi's finely nuanced statement to Russian president Vladimir Putin at his bilateral meeting with him at the SCO summit in Samarkand in September has changed that perception. Modi told Putin that "today is not an era of war" even while reassuring him that the two countries share "an unbreakable friendship". The West has widely appreciated the subtle shift in India's approach. "We made it amply clear that we are not in favour of war and are happy to do anything to contribute towards peace through diplomacy and dialogue," says a senior official.

The G20 communique in Bali saw India deftly finding a way out of the deadlock by quoting the UN General Assembly resolution condemning Russia for invading Ukraine rather than the G20 doing so directly. It saw even Russia sign on the communique, showing off India in excellent light as a consensus-builder. Bala Venkatesh Varma, a former Indian ambassador to Russia, says, "Indian diplomacy has demonstrated a high level of pragmatism. At Bali, India kept its doors open to everyone who matters on the subject. Then we kept the side channels open with Russia and key players on the western side, something even Indonesia, which was